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TikTok sputters back to life in US

Reprieve comes as Trump said he would stall ban

By David McCabe
NEW YORK TIMES
WASHINGTON — TikTok flickered back to life in the United States on Sunday after President-elect Donald Trump said he would issue an executive order to stall a federal ban of the app.

The abrupt shift came just hours after major app stores removed the popular social media site and it stopped operating for US users as a federal law took effect. The company said in a post on the social platform X that in “agreement with our service providers, TikTok is in the process of restoring service.”

Trump said in a Sunday morning post on Truth Social that he would “issue an executive order on Monday to extend the period of time before the law’s prohibitions take effect, so that we can make a deal to protect our national security.”

The ban stems from a 2024 law that requires app stores and cloud computing providers to stop distributing or hosting TikTok unless it is sold by its Chinese parent company, ByteDance. Lawmakers passed the law over concerns that the Chinese government could use the app, which claims roughly 170 million US users, to gather information about Americans or spread propaganda.

App stores and cloud computing providers are expected to comply with the law. **TIKTOK, Page A7**



Take a spin through the most expensive homes sold last year in the state, including one (above) in Boston’s Back Bay. **D1.**

Parents are concerned about students’ languishing math skills, a poll shows. **B1.**

The demolition of the 75-year-old White Stadium in Franklin Park is slated to begin this week. **C1.**



Do solemnly shiver

Monday: Clearing, cold. High 24-29, low 10-15.
Tuesday: Frigid, breezy. High 17-22, low 8-13.
High tide: 3:27, 3:47.
Sunrise: 7:08. Sunset: 4:43.
Weather and comics, **D4-5.**
Obituaries, **C9.**

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AVISHAG SHAAR-YASHUV/NEW YORK TIMES

Emily Damari, one of the Israeli hostages released from captivity in Gaza after the cease-fire started, arrived at Sheba Hospital in Ramat Gan, near Tel Aviv. She had been shot and kidnapped from her home at a kibbutz in southern Israel on Oct. 7, 2023.

Hope springs in streets of despair

Three Israeli hostages released as cautious celebrations replace bomb blasts in Gaza

By Aaron Boxerman, Bilal Shbair, and Hiba Yazbek
NEW YORK TIMES

JERUSALEM — The sounds of celebration replaced those of explosions in the Gaza Strip on Sunday as a fragile cease-fire came into effect after 470 days of war, allowing some hostages to return home to Israel, Palestinians imprisoned in Israel to be released, and displaced Palestinians to search for what was left of their homes in Gaza.

Under the terms of the laboriously reached deal, fighting between the Israeli military and Hamas militants stopped at 11:15 a.m., raising hopes for a more lasting end to a war that has plunged the Middle East into fear and uncertainty.

The first hostages — three women seized when Hamas attacked Israel



AFIF AMIREH/NEW YORK TIMES

Released Palestinian prisoners greeted supporters Sunday in Ramallah, West Bank, following the cease-fire agreement.

on Oct. 7, 2023 — were released shortly afterward. Early Monday, the Israeli prison service said it had released 90 Palestinian prisoners being held in Israel, where they were met by excited family members.

At the same time, stepped-up aid deliveries — more than 630 trucks in a single day — made their way into Gaza.

Joyous Palestinians honked car horns and blasted music in the central Gaza city of Deir al Balah, where children ran around in the streets. Israelis celebrated, too, as the hostages began returning, with anxious families anticipating the release of still more.

But underlying the relief was the knowledge that this phase of the cease-fire is to last just 42 days and free only some of the hostages, and **CEASE FIRE, Page A10**

Trump pledges immediate spate of unilateral moves

By Will Weissert, Fatima Hussein, and Josh Boak
ASSOCIATED PRESS

WASHINGTON — President-elect Donald Trump used a raucous rally Sunday on the eve of his inauguration to promise swift Day 1 action remaking the federal government, shifting federal priorities at breakneck speed, and ensuring that “the curtain closes on four long years of American decline.”

Supporters filled nearly all of the 20,000-plus-seat Capital One Arena

in downtown Washington for a “Make America Great” victory celebration and cheered as Trump said he’d take quick action on everything from cracking down on the US-Mexico border to promoting oil drilling, reining in the federal workforce, and eradicating diversity programs.

“We’re going to give them the best first day, the biggest first week, and the most extraordinary first 100 days of any presidency in American history,” said Trump, who also promised to

INAUGURATION, Page A7

INAUGURATION DAY

A case for visa reform

With H1-B visas on the line, it’s time to think bigger on changes, Hiawatha Bray writes. **D1.**

A foreign affair

The president-elect, for the first time in US history, invited foreign leaders to the inauguration. **A5.**

Moving day

It gets easier the second time around, said Melania Trump. **A6.**

For activists, a day to honor King, rededicate selves



BRETT PHELPS FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

From left, Cecily Graham, Asha Janay, and Braxton Campbell listened at a Boston Common event Friday linked to Martin Luther King Day.

By Tiana Woodard and Danny McDonald
GLOBE STAFF

The speakers honoring the legacy of the Rev. Martin Luther King Jr. on Boston Common last week did not duck the irony Monday will bring: the day King is to be nationally celebrated will also mark the return of a man to the White House who many fear will erode the values the civil rights giant embodied.

“This weekend is a profound and painful contradiction,” Representative Ayanna Pressley told the crowd of about 100 gathered around the Parkman Bandstand Friday afternoon.

People looking to carry on King’s legacy in Boston used the time leading up **MLK DAY, Page A6**

►The Rev. Martin Luther King Jr. took his resistance to Boston with a march and speech 60 years ago. **B1.**

Immigrants fear policy could split families

Parents face choice with US-born children

By Jason Laughlin and Anjali Huynh
GLOBE STAFF

As a second Trump administration dawns Monday, thousands of immigrant families statewide are reckoning with the looming threat of forced separation from their American-born children.

Civil rights and immigration lawyers are scrambling to help undocumented parents at risk of deportation or detention make arrangements for their children’s safety. Advocacy organizations have been holding information sessions for migrant parents, and the Office of Attorney General Andrea Campbell is working with schools to help protect children, as a shadow of fear spreads across immigrant communities.

Parents face “a difficult choice between whether the child will relocate to a country they’ve never lived in or stay here without them,” said Elizabeth Sweet, executive director of Massachusetts Immigrant & Refugee Advocacy Coalition.

In 2022, about 30,100 Massachusetts children with US citizenship had at least one undocumented parent, according to a report from the American Immigration **IMMIGRANTS, Page A4**